freedom to critics of the state" and that its Council for Higher Education "conducts inquisitions among university faculty, seeking to harass, demote, or fire dissidents."[3] She offers not a single example as evidence of such repressive measures.[4] Denouncing what she calls the country's "brutal apartheid system," she further claims that the Israeli "military interferes with Palestinians' access to university education."[5] In fact, there are now numerous institutions of higher learning in the territories, all of them created since 1967. Palestinian students who live in these areas attend them on a daily basis. As for Israeli Arabs, had Scott bothered to check, she would have found that they make up 11.2% of the undergraduate student population in Israel's major research universities (at Haifa university, the figure is closer to 30%). If one adds those studying in Israel's regional colleges, the figure rises. In addition, Arabs make up something like 22% of students in the country's medical schools. These figures compare pretty well to the enrollment of minority students in American colleges and universities and testify against Scott's charge that Israel intentionally impedes Arab access to higher education. As one of her critics remarks, "asserting something is not the same thing as substantiating it," but Scott sets aside such academic niceties as the presentation of corroborating proof and rests her case entirely on vilifying statements.[6]

So do others in the BDS movement. According to Bill Mullen, a professor of English and American Studies at Purdue University and another contributor to this special issue of the *Journal of Academic Freedom*, Israel's sins long precede its present-day educational policies and began with the establishment of the state itself: "The creation of the state of Israel in 1948 on land home to generations of Arab Palestinians is the contemporary world's most egregious instance of settler colonialism." He continued: "Israeli crimes of racial discrimination and segregation against the Palestinian citizens of Israel resemble the defunct apartheid system in South Africa."

As extreme as this denunciatory rhetoric is, it gets worse. Curtis Marez, who was president of the ASA at the time of the organization's boycott resolution, was a signatory to a 2009 letter to President Obama accusing Israel of pursuing an "insidious policy of extermination" so merciless in its character and extent as to constitute "one of the most massive ethnocidal atrocities of modern times." Although the charge is groundless, the letter that contains it, which labels Israel a "racist regime," an "apartheid regime," and a "criminal regime,"[7] was signed by more than 900 academic scholars.[8]

The language I have been citing is full of familiar buzzwords and political clichés about Israeli "racism," "colonialism," "ethnic cleansing," and the like. This is now standard fare in "progressive" academic circles. Yet any scholar

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